Long hole bored lamps

Colwin Way uses the long hole boring technique to make two lamp designs

COLWIN WAY

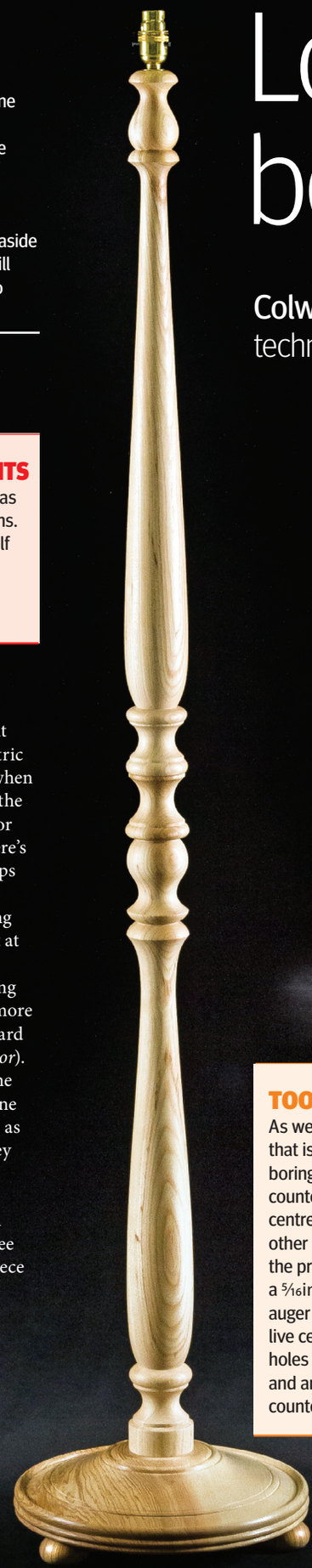
PHOTOGRAPHS BY COLWIN WAY

Colwin started turning aged 13 and has since gone on to teach the craft and wishes to continue to give people confidence to try the wonderful hobby for themselves. Colwin was born and grew up in Lyme Regis, a small seaside town in the southwest of England, and is still living in the area with his wife Vicki and two sons, Finley and Charlie.

colwinway@btinternet.com
www.axminsterskillcentre.co.uk

SAFETY & LEGAL REQUIREMENTS

- In many countries the wiring of lamps has to be undertaken by qualified electricians. Do not attempt to wire the lamp yourself without first seeking professional guidance and make sure you follow the current, relevant legislation



Long hole boring is a method that is most commonly used for drilling out the lengths of lamps to take the electric cable. There can be a number of pitfalls when drilling these long lengths and probably the most common is the wander of the drill or auger bit. On a short length generally there's no issue, but when turning standard lamps or long single pieces then the chance of wander increases, especially when drilling from both ends requires the drill to meet at the halfway point.

To demonstrate this technique I'm going to make a single-piece lamp from a sycamore (*Acer pseudoplatanus*) blank and a standard three-piece lamp in ash (*Fraxinus excelsior*). The design for the single-piece lamp is one I've been using for over 30 years; it was one of the most popular lamp designs I made as an apprentice and was created by Geoffrey Manley, my then boss. What I like about this design is that it can be stretched and compressed from standard lamp to small vase shapes and if you look hard, you'll see some of its characteristics in the three-piece lamp too.

TOOLS FOR LONG HOLE BORING

As well as the normal turning tools, there is a range of tooling that is specific to long hole boring, such as augers, counterbores and hollow live centres. I'm also using a few other bits and bobs to make the process easier, including a 5/16in auger bit, a cam lock auger bit holder, a hollow live centre with exhaust holes to expel the shavings and an interchangeable counterbore/boring head.

Tools for long hole boring

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